

05 • THE IDEA

A draft, edited in public.

The brand is a piece of writing with the editing left visible. Everything follows from that.

- 1 **If a sentence can lose a word, it will.**
Cut it before the client does. Shorter is almost always truer.
- 2 **Funny is a tool, not a costume.**
The joke has to carry information. If it only decorates, it goes.
- 3 **The brief is half the writing.**
Ask the awkward question early. It is cheaper than a rewrite.
- 4 **Write for a reply, not for approval.**
Every piece should make the next step obvious and easy to take.
- 5 **The black layer has to work alone.**
Jokes live in the red layer. Take the red away and the meaning must survive: that is what Dry mode proves.

THE DIAL

Cheek is set at 3 out of 5. Dry, deadpan, quietly rude about the industry, never zany, never a pun for the sake of it. The tone a good editor uses in the margin: honest, a bit tired, on your side.

THE TWO LAYERS

Black type carries the meaning. Red carries the opinion. A reader who only reads the black gets the full story; a reader who reads both gets the company. Dry mode on the website is the test: switch it on, every red mark disappears, and nothing stops making sense.

if the joke is load-bearing, it isn't a joke. it's a bug.

05 • HABITS

How the sentences behave.

RULES OF THUMB

- Headlines are sentence case and end with a full stop. They are statements, not labels.
- Margin notes are lower case, under twelve words, and never contain the offer.
- Buttons say what happens: See the work, Hire the pen, Next mail.
- Numbers are written as numerals when they are facts (27 cold mails), as words when they are rhetoric (four people).
- No exclamation marks. The joke has to survive a full stop.
- Indian English, spelled British: colour, organise, programme.
- Say the price question plainly: priced per project, once we understand it.

WORDS WE DON'T USE

synergy	unlock your potential
leverage (as a verb)	curated
passionate about	game-changing
we're excited to announce	in today's fast-paced world
revert back	solutions provider
kindly do the needful	“!” at the end of a sentence

Not because they are banned words, but because every one of them is a sentence that has stopped trying. If one turns up in a draft, there is a better, shorter, truer line underneath it.

05 • READY-MADE

Copy you can paste.

read it out loud. if you run out of breath, cut it.

25 WORDS

The Dry Text Co. is a content, marketing, advertising, branding and website agency from Ahmedabad, writing for brands that would rather be read than skimmed.

50 WORDS

The Dry Text Co. is a creative agency from Ahmedabad. We write the words brands get judged by, and build the websites those words live on: brand copy, social, long-form, advertising and strategy. Four people, one red pen, and a habit of cutting every sentence that can lose a word.

100 WORDS

The Dry Text Co. is a content, marketing, advertising, branding and website agency from Ahmedabad, working with brands anywhere in the world. We write the words a brand gets judged by, and design and build the websites those words live on. That covers brand and web copy, social and marketing, advertising, long-form and content strategy. The work is done by four people, not a queue, so you always talk to the person actually writing it. We price per project, once we understand it. And we keep a red pen on everything, including our own drafts, because the second version is usually the one worth sending.

TAGLINES

Don't go by the name, cuz we cheesy.

The house line. Use it where the audience already knows the name.

A content-writing agency from Ahmedabad, for brands anywhere in the world that would rather be read than skimmed.

The explaining line. Use it first, everywhere else.

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